CHAPTER 04 / TRAINING

Build your program

A plan that fits your life.

Turn exercise choices into a sustainable week.

How to use this guide

Read the explanations, try the practical examples and complete the worksheet. All training logs and menus are illustrative. Use the website for interactive tools; this document remains useful offline.

01	02	03
Understand	Put into practice	Review

Scope and safety

General education for adults, not a medical diagnosis, personalized treatment or a guaranteed transformation. Stop exercise for sharp pain or unusual symptoms. A qualified clinician, dietitian or coach can help when individual circumstances require assessment.

What you will learn

01. Start with your calendar
02. Cover the major patterns
03. Start modestly, adjust deliberately
04. Match experience to complexity

01 / Start with your calendar

Two or three full-body days can be practical for a beginner. Upper/lower splits distribute work across four days. Push/pull/legs divides sessions by movement groups. A body-part split can work, but missing one session may leave a muscle untrained for longer.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: Choose a schedule you can keep during a busy week, not only an ideal one.

02 / Cover the major patterns

Include a knee-dominant exercise, a hip hinge, a push and a pull across the week. Add accessories when helpful. Select exercises that you can perform comfortably and progressively. No single exercise is compulsory for muscle growth.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: A squat, Romanian deadlift, push-up and row form a useful starting framework.

03 / Start modestly, adjust deliberately

Begin with manageable work and increase only when performance and recovery support it. Count challenging sets across all exercises, including overlap. More sets can be useful, but adding work indefinitely produces fatigue and diminishing returns.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: If two pressing exercises already fatigue your triceps, consider that before adding many extensions.

04 / Match experience to complexity

Beginners benefit from practicing repeatable movements. Intermediate trainees may spread work over more days or target a lagging movement. Advanced trainees often need finer fatigue management. A complicated split does not make a person advanced.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: Use the builder to save exercises, sets, reps and rest for each training day.

Practical reference

Example training week

An editable beginner example; start with manageable loads and comfortable range. This is not a personalized prescription.

Day	Movements	Example work
Monday	Goblet squat, push-up, cable row	2 sets each; controlled reps
Wednesday	Romanian deadlift, pulldown, shoulder press	2 sets each; controlled reps
Friday	Split squat, dumbbell press, row	2 sets each; controlled reps
Other days	Rest or comfortable light activity	Adjust to recovery

Example double progression

Session	Load	Repetitions	Decision
A	10 kg	10 / 10 / 9	Practice at same load
B	10 kg	11 / 10 / 10	Keep technique consistent
C	10 kg	12 / 12 / 12	Consider smallest load increase
D	Next suitable load	Return toward 8 reps	Review effort and control

These sessions are fictional and have no promised dates. Progression should follow readiness rather than an obligation to lift more every workout.

Your study worksheet

Knowledge check

The most useful split is usually the one that...

A. Fits your schedule and recovery

B. Has the most days

C. Changes every week

Reflect and apply

Prompt	Your response
One idea I can explain in my own words	
One action I can try this week	
What I will observe or measure	
What would make me seek professional guidance	
My next review date	

Chapter summary

Choose sustainable days, cover major movements and adjust volume using your own response.

Answer and explanation

A. A repeatable schedule makes consistent practice possible.

Sources & limitations

These sources inform the educational principles. Original examples and planning templates are not study findings. No institution listed below endorses this journal. References checked November 2026.

ACSM (2026) — Resistance training prescription: overview of reviews

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41843416/

Interpretation matters

Research describes groups under particular conditions. Individual responses vary. The website models are simplified illustrations, not precise physiological simulations. Food values and calorie estimates are approximate. Use consistent observation and individualized professional support when needed.